

INTERNATIONAL news

Nvidia fabricates its first AI chip in the US

Nvidia has begun producing its first AI chips domestically at



TSMC's facility in Phoenix, Arizona, taking a step forward in US-based chip manufacturing. The move comes alongside plans to build supercomputer assembly plants in Texas, as the company aims to strengthen its US supply chain, meet the booming demand for AI, and boost resilience.

China lifts export ban on key tech metals

China has suspended its export ban on key tech materials, including gallium, germanium, antimony, and graphite, until 27 November 2026, easing trade tensions with the US. The move follows the October 30 Xi-Trump meeting in South Korea, where both leaders agreed to scale back tariffs. China, which produces 94% of global gallium and 83% of germanium, aims to stabilise relations after years of trade conflict and tariff escalation.

TSMC to begin construction of 1.4 nanometre chip facilities

TSMC will begin to construct a new chip fabrication plant for its 1.4nm or A14 chips. The company has completed its planning and bidding process and aims to start mass production in H2 2028. The investment is estimated at approximately \$49 billion and is expected to create up to 10,000 jobs. The plant expands TSMC's advanced manufacturing capacity for chips that power artificial intelligence data centres and high-performance computing systems.

Tesla nears multi-year battery supply deal with Samsung SDI

Samsung SDI is in the final stage of negotiations with Tesla to supply energy storage system battery cells worth US\$2.1 billion. The multi-year supply agreement will strengthen Tesla's shift toward South Korean battery makers as the company diversifies its supply chains away from China. The deal is expected to cover approximately 10 gigawatt-hours of lithium-iron-phosphate battery cells annually.

RAAAM secures \$17.5 million from NXP to advance qualification of GCRAM tech

RAAAM Memory Technologies has raised \$17.5 million in an oversubscribed Series A round led by NXP Semiconductors. The new investment brings RAAAM's total funding to over \$24 million, including equity and a grant from the EIC Accelerator program. The funds will be used to advance the qualification of RAAAM's patented GCRAM technology in leading-edge process nodes at top-tier semiconductor foundries.

Nokia and Rohde & Schwarz collaborate on AI-based 6G receivers

Nokia and Rohde & Schwarz collaborate on a new 6G receiver that leverages artificial intelligence to enhance signal coverage and reduce network deployment costs. Nokia develops the receiver, while Rohde & Schwarz provides its testing equipment to validate the results. Their joint tests show that the AI-based receiver improves uplink distance by 10 to 25 per cent compared with current technologies.

SK Group and Nvidia unite to build South Korea's AI future

SK Group and Nvidia have partnered to drive breakthroughs in high-bandwidth memory, semiconductor manufacturing, and artificial intelligence infrastructure in South Korea. The partnership will result in the creation of one of the country's largest AI factories, powered by over 50,000 Nvidia GPUs. The facility aims to accelerate research, digital transformation, and AI innovation across industries in South Korea.

US startup challenges ASML and TSMC with next-gen lithography technology

Substrate, an American startup, is challenging the dominance of ASML and TSMC with its novel lithography technology that uses particle accelerators to generate ultra-short-wave X-rays. The company claims that prototypes already support a 2-nanometre process and aims to slash wafer costs dramatically by the end of the decade. While investor backing is strong, analysts caution that replicating ASML's precision and TSMC's manufacturing scale remains a long-term endeavour.

SoftBank sells entire Nvidia stake for \$5.83 billion

SoftBank has sold its entire Nvidia stake for \$5.83 billion, offloading 32.1 million shares in October to free capital for major tech investments, including its \$22.5 billion commitment to OpenAI. The company also sold part of its T-Mobile stake for \$9.17 billion as part of its asset monetisation push, aiming to maintain a strong, 'ready' funding capacity.

Delvitech raises \$40 million for global expansion

Delvitech raised US\$40 million in a Series B round led by EGS Beteiligungen, marking one of Switzerland's most significant deep tech investments. The funds will support global expansion and the construction of a new plant in India by 2026, with a target of 200 machines per month by 2030. Delvitech expects 400% sales growth by the end of 2025. Its AI inspection systems serve automotive, telecom, and industrial sectors with predictive defect detection.

Chipmind raises 2.5 million US\$ and unveils AI agents for chip design

Chipmind has launched its AI-driven platform, Chipmind Agents, aiming to transform semiconductor development by automating complex chip design and verification tasks. The firm also announced a \$2.5 million pre-seed funding round, led by Founderful and supported by angel investors from the semiconductor industry.

Samsung posts strong Q3 profits driven by AI demand

Samsung Electronics reported better third-quarter results for 2025, driven by record memory sales and strong performance in smartphones. Consolidated revenue rose 15.4% from the previous quarter to KRW86.1 trillion, while operating profit surged to KRW12.2 trillion. The 'Device Solutions' Division led the growth, with a 19% jump in quarterly sales.

China grants exemptions on Nexperia chip export curbs for civilian use

China has granted exemptions allowing Nexperia chips to be exported for civilian use, easing concerns among global automakers and electronics manufacturers. The move softens earlier export curbs that had disrupted supply chains following regulatory pressure on the Dutch-owned company. While Beijing has not detailed which applications qualify, the exemptions signal a more flexible approach aimed at stabilising chip availability for key industries.